

CHIVALRY'S NOT DEAD

Written by

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INT. FAIRYTALE LAND - CASTLE DINING HALL - DINNER

We open on a grand dining hall where three people eat dinner together.

A KING, (50s), sits at the head of the table, and speaks with confidence and an air of self-righteousness.

KING MERAS

Today, I met with my advisors about building a new wing to this castle - what do you all think we should name it?

A QUEEN, (50s), sitting to King Meras's right, is kind, but knows how to get the best out of her husband.

QUEEN LILLIAN

I think naming it after someone in our lineage would be splendid, as long as that someone isn't you.

A PRINCESS, (20s), laughs, sitting opposite Queen Lillian. She has her mother's sense of humor, and her father's boldness.

PRINCESS SHELBY

Let's be fair, we've never named something after the best King this land was ruled by.

KING MERAS

Thank you, dear.

PRINCESS SHELBY

We should name it after mother's father.

The women laugh as King Meras sits there livid.

KING MERAS

What do you think, Damien?

We reveal that a fourth person has been eating with them quietly, on the left of Princess Shelby sits a KNIGHT, Damien, (20s), quiet, but only to mind his own business.

He looks up from his food, and speaks innocently.

DAMIEN

Maybe we could name it after one of the advisors. They've been with us for decades, haven't they?

QUEEN LILLIAN
He has a point.

KING MERAS
No, he doesn't. Castle's are named
after great rulers and fighters,
not something you would know.

Everyone falls silent at this remark.

DAMIEN
I'm sorry, father. I-

Suddenly, a DRAGON BURSTS into the HALL! It begins attacking
the family!

KING MERAS
SON! PICK UP YOUR SWORD AND FIGHT!

Damien, FROZEN, looks on into the terror that's happening.

He snaps back to reality, and immediately comes to his
father's aid. They try to fend off the Dragon with their
weapons, but it SPRAYS FIRE, destroying everything.

The CEILING comes CRASHING DOWN. Queen Lillian and Princess
Shelby try to get out of the way, but almost fall off what's
left of the hall.

KING MERAS (CONT'D)
GO HELP YOUR MOTHER AND SISTER!

Damien turns his attention, and he must make a choice. He
runs for his sister first!

He's able to grab her, but she SLIPS!

Damien backs away from the edge, horrified by what's just
happened.

Queen Lillian starts slipping as well, and King Meras takes a
beating from the Dragon! Damien is overwhelmed by the terror,
and incapable of dealing with it, HE RUNS AWAY!

INT. FAIRYTALE LAND - MAGIC FOREST - CONTINUOUS

Damien runs frantically, trying to forget the reality of what
just happened. He goes until he sees a figure in the
distance.

He stops to consider what he's about do, but continues
knowing it's his only option.

(O.S.)
I can't say this is a surprise.

DAMIEN
I have nothing else. My father once told me the magic of the wizard could be the only thing to help me become who I truly am.

The figure turns around to reveal A WIZARD, Dumbledore looking

THE WIZARD
Who might that be?

DAMIEN
I don't know. I only know I can't be what he wants me to be, and that means I can't be here anymore. Will you help me?

THE WIZARD
Hmm. I can take you to a place where you will see who you're truly meant to be.

DAMIEN
Do it please.

THE WIZARD
But, there will be a price.

DAMIEN
I will pay it, any cost.

THE WIZARD
Then, it is done. Your time here is over.

A billow of smoke, some magic dust, and POOF!

TITLE CARD - CHIVALRY'S NOT DEAD

INT. FOSTER HOME - ALEX'S BEDROOM - MORNING

ALEX, (middle school), a foster kid who's sure of herself, but not too sure of herself, is sitting up in bed reading a book.

She sets the book down on a nearby nightstand where we see the cover dons a knight fighting a dragon.

We catch a glimpse of the time - 6:59 AM - before it turns the hour and BRING!!!

All around the room are different foster kids who begin to stir from sleep, and before you know it, everyone is rushing to get ready.

Alex is reluctant to get out of bed and start the day, but she talks a minute to psych herself up.

ALEX
(to herself)
You can do this. New day means new
adventure. It's always an
adventure.

She finally gets out of bed to use the bathroom, but is blocked by three other people trying to use it at the same time - it's clear she's not familiar with them.

Annoyed, she waits her turn.

ALEX (CONT'D)
(to herself)
This is the lamest start to an
adventure ever.

INT. FOSTER HOME - FRONT DOOR - MOMENTS LATER

The kids walk out to get on the bus, but Alex is held back by TESS, (30s), - their caring, but spread thin foster mom.

TESS
How are you feeling, hon?

ALEX
Fine.

TESS
Alright, well you tell me if
there's anything I can do to make
you feel more at home. Go on now,
don't be late.

Alex shrugs this off and gets on the bus.

INT. BUS - CONTINUOUS

Alex finds her way down the aisle and plops herself next to CORY, (middle school), a sweet and curious boy the same age as Alex, and her best friend.

CORY
Hey! Everything alright?

ALEX
Everything, but having to learn
eight new names this week.

CORY
Well what's your new foster mom's
name?

ALEX
Tess. She's-

CORY
That's pretty! She sounds like
someone who cares very much about
you and will always keep you safe!

ALEX
Well, she act likes someone who
doesn't care that much and is just
doing a job.

CORY
C'mon Alex, you just have to give
her a chance. They could be the
one.

ALEX
There's not going to be a one,
Cory, and it's really okay.

CORY
At least school will be fun!

Alex lets out a guttural sigh.

CORY (CONT'D)
Did you bring them?

ALEX
Do you think I could survive
without them?

Alex unzips her backpack and pulls out FAIRY TALE BOOKS.

Cory grabs them and looks through the titles.

CORY
Ooo, mermaid princess! The one with
the beanstalk is great! Rumpel.. I
don't know how to say that, but
it's looks cool-

ALEX

Ya, that's new! I just thought it
looked funny.
(giggles)

CORY

And- why is Damien one here?

ALEX

I like that one! I don't know, it
just never gets old for me.

CORY

So you'll come over after school?

ALEX

If I can make it through class with
Ms. Lily.

INT. SCHOOL - HOME ROOM - MIDDLE OF THE SCHOOL DAY

MS. LILY, (30s), a soft-spoken and positive woman, is at the
front of the room talking to the class.

She's teaching a history lesson, which we can see by the
title and related on information written on the board behind
her.

MS. LILY

So, in America, we'd say the leader
of our country is The President.
But, he doesn't get to choose all
the rules. Our country runs on
something called Democracy which
is...

The lecture fades into noise briefly as we notice that Alex
is in her own world, nose buried in her desk.

She sketches away in a notebook already filled with lots of
sketches of fairy tale characters.

MS. LILY (CONT'D)

A country like England, for
example, is lead by a King and a
Queen. Can anyone tell me what
that's called? Alex?

Alex's head shoots up, her face blank, but pencil still in
hand.

Ms. Lily stares persistently and Alex looks to Cory for help.

Cory tries to mouth the word "Monarchy".

ALEX
A... Monopoly?

The class laughs, and Alex sulks back into her notebook.

RING!! The period is over.

MS. LILY
That's lunch! Don't forget when you
go home to remind your parents
tomorrow is 'Bring your parent to
school day' and we're having
presentations in this classroom!

Most of the class clears out.

Cory walks over to Alex who's still hiding her face, and pats
her for comfort.

Ms. Lily walks over too.

MS. LILY (CONT'D)
Alex, dear, what happened today?

ALEX
(throws her hands up)
I'm just stupid!

MS. LILY
I know you're a bright girl. All I
see you and Cory do during break is
read, and that's amazing! But when
you're in class, you need to get
your head out of the fairy tales.
(she points at the
sketches)
Can you try that for me?

ALEX
Yeah, I'll try.

MS. LILY
Great. Will you be bringing someone
to class tomorrow?

ALEX
I don't think so, I don't really
have anyone to-

CORY
You could ask Tess! She's her new
foster mom.

Alex shoots him a look of resistance.

INT. SCHOOL - HALLWAY - MOMENTS LATER

Alex and Cory head from class to the lunchroom.

ALEX

That really wasn't cool, Cory. I don't feel like Tess will even care to go.

CORY

She will too! You just gotta give her the chance! Don't you want to know if she could come with you?

ALEX

I guess. I'll ask, fine.

CORY

Awesome! I really hope there's corn in the cafeteria today.

As they're walking, a trio of boys from class confront Alex.

CHASE and ETHAN, are lead by JACK (all same age)- Alex's bullies who just love being the brats they are.

JACK

You were funny in there, Alex. It's always funny when you try to answer questions in class, actually.

The boys snicker.

ALEX

Ya? I think it's funny when you're face shows up in class.

CHASE

Your face looks stupider than his!

ALEX

It's still smarter than your brain.

JACK

At least my face is loved by two parents.

This shuts Alex up.

CORY

That's not funny.

ETHAN

Your face is funny too, Cory.

CORY

Whatever, just leave us alone.

JACK

Can't wait to see who you show up
with tomorrow, Alex!

The trio strides off, triumphant.

Alex is hurting, and Cory tries to comfort her.

CORY

Forget those idiots, they're just
being mean. You're way smarter than
them.

ALEX

Thanks Cory, but they're right.

CORY

What? The face thing? Your face is
better looking than theirs, trust
me.

ALEX

(laughs)

No, I just mean, ugghhh. I wish
someone could be there for me
tomorrow. I really hope, Tess says
yes.

CORY

She will, I just know it!

INT. CORY'S HOUSE - CORY'S BASEMENT - AFTER SCHOOL

Alex and Cory arrive at the bottom of the stairs and drop
their backpacks on a nearby couch.

ALEX

Can I use your phone? I have to
tell Tess that I'm staying here
tonight.

Cory dashes back up the stairs.

Alex plops down on the couch and decides to go through her
fairy tale books.

She pulls out the one with Damien and flips through.

We land on a page that sees Damien being embraced by a king and queen. Alex stares at this page.

Cory comes back down with a phone in hand, which he gives to Alex. Alex dials a number and waits.

TESS (V.O.)

Hello?

ALEX

Hey Tess, it's Alex. I'm calling from Cory's home phone. We- I wanted to have a sleepover tonight, if that's ok.

TESS (V.O.)

Did his mom say it's ok?

ALEX

Yeah, we just asked, she doesn't mind.

TESS (V.O.)

Alright, I can pick you up in the morning. Have fun-

ALEX

Actually, I wanted to ask you something... my teacher said tomorrow was 'Bring your parents to school day' and I don't have parents obviously, but I thought it would be okay if you came with me, so I was wondering... could you?

TESS (V.O.)

Oh Alex, I'd really love to, but you know I have a responsibility to stay at home and take care of some of the younger kids with us, so I can't really leave, I'm so sorry.

The line goes quiet for a minute as Alex absorbs this.

ALEX

It's fine, it really is. I'll see you tomorrow.

Alex hangs up without waiting for a response. She sits back, reeling.

Cory looks on sympathetically.

CORY
It's going to be alright, my mom
could go with both of us. I
promise, we'll still have fun.

ALEX
My life is just not normal, and
that sucks.

POOF!

Alex and Cory suddenly hear a loud noise outside. They look
to the window just in time to see a FLASH of LIGHT, and a
FIGURE FALLS FROM THE SKY!

CORY
What was that?!

ALEX
Is it just me or was that...?

She trails off, her curiosity gets the better of her, and she
jumps up.

CORY
Where are you going?!?!

ALEX
(excited)
We have to see what that was!

She rushes out of the basement, and Cory follows scared.

EXT. CORY'S BACKYARD - CONTINUOUS

Alex sprints out of the house and to the spot the figure fell
from and she stops dead in her tracks!

A KNIGHT in FULL ARMOR groggily makes his way to his feet in
front of Alex. Alex stands in awe.

CORY
WHAT ARE YOU DOING IN MY BACKYARD?!

Alex whips around to see Cory brandishing a plastic sword.

ALEX
Stop! Stop, he's a good guy! We can
just talk to him!

CORY
He's a STRANGER!

Alex yanks the sword free of Cory's grasp, and Cory jumps behind Alex, scared.

ALEX
Who are you? Where did you come
from?

Damien stares on without expression, still finding his balance.

ALEX (CONT'D)
(to cory)
I don't think he understands us.

CORY
Ask him.

Alex points the sword in Damien's face and asks

ALEX
Do you speak English?

DAMIEN
GET THAT AWAY FROM ME!!!

At the first sight of violence, Damien takes off RUNNING.

CORY
What'd you do??

ALEX
(to Damien)
WAIT! We come in peace!

She wastes no time and runs after him.

CORY
(to himself)
Why does she keep running?

Cory reluctantly runs after her.

EXT. GAS STATION - CONTINUOUS

Damien sees a convenience store attached to this gas station, and makes his way towards the entrance.

He carefully studies the cars and machines he passes by, eerily cautious not to come into contact with anything too foreign.

He finds the doors to the store, and walks up. The doors open automatically, and Damien JUMPS back!

He looks up and down to find the trick, but can't seem to place it. He raises his shield, and approaches the door slowly. It OPENS AGAIN, and he must jump back.

Damien readies himself, shield up, and CHARGES the door!

INT. CONVENIENCE STORE - CONTINUOUS

Damien makes inside unscathed as the automatic doors do their job. He lifts his head up and straightens his armor, proud of making it past the contraption.

STORE CLERK (O.S.)

Welcome!

Damien ignores this captivated by the smell of HOT DOGS turning nearby. He walks up and inspects the food.

After a moment of thought, he BREAKS the window and grabs the hot dogs. He stuffs them in his mouth, satisfied.

STORE CLERK (O.S.) (CONT'D)

Sir? You need to pay for that.

Next, Damien takes notice of the slushies spinning in their machine. He knocks on the window, and feels around before grabbing the handle and yanking it. BLUE SLUSHIE flows out of the spout.

Damien tries again, and more slushie falls. He holds the handle down and carefully tries to smell what's coming out. Tongue outstretched he tries a sample, and decides he LOVES it. He starts taking comically large gulps of slushie straight from the machine.

STORE CLERK (O.S.) (CONT'D)

Sir, if you're high I'm going to need you to leave.

Just then, Alex and Cory barge in.

ALEX

What are you doing!!

Damien stands up almost embarrassed, and hits head on the way.

STORE CLERK (O.S.)

(to Alex)

Is he with you? You guys are going to need to pay for all that or I'm calling the cops.

ALEX
Sorry, my dad gets hungry... in his
sleep. Sometimes, he goes to the
fridge, sometimes he goes to the
gas station.

She gives a fake laugh, and a smile.

STORE CLERK (O.S.)
Just tell him to pay.

ALEX
You got it, mister.

Alex walks hurriedly up to Damien, who is eyeing things in
the fridge section, and taps him on the armor.

ALEX (CONT'D)
Hello, magic stranger guy, we need
to talk.

Damien pretends not to hear her, and continues moving along
the section looking at food.

ALEX (CONT'D)
Hey, I'm talking to you! I know you
understand me, why do you keep
running away? We're just trying to
talk to you.

Damien tries to walk away.

ALEX (CONT'D)
If you're a knight, why don't you
treat me with a little respect?

Damien stops in his tracks.

DAMIEN
I'm not a knight. My name is
Damien.

ALEX
You sure look like one, Damien.

CORY
You kind of do.

DAMIEN
Stay away from me. We have no
business together, leave me alone.

ALEX
We're just trying to help!

STORE CLERK (O.S.)
I'm going to call the cops if you
don't pay right now.

ALEX
Well, I'm not going to jail, let's
leave Cory.

DAMIEN
Jail? Why did the man speak of
jail?

ALEX
You're going to jail if you don't
come with us.

DAMIEN
Go on.

ALEX
Follow me.

The three hide behind a row of drinks close to the exit.

ALEX (CONT'D)
(to the clerk)
Sir? We're ready to check out, but
can you help us with something?

STORE CLERK (O.S.)
What is it now? Stay where you are,
I'm coming.

Alex hears this and grabs a soda from the shelf. She SHAKES
it as hard as she can, the soda FIZZES, and she UNLEASHES a
BLAST of soda into the air!

STORE CLERK (O.S.) (CONT'D)
WHAT THE F--!

ALEX
RUN!!!

The three sprint out of the store without looking back.

INT. CORY'S HOUSE - CORY'S BASEMENT - LATER

Cory brings snacks and drinks down to the basement where Alex
and Damien sit on the couch talking.

ALEX
So, what are you doing here?

DAMIEN

I'm not sure. I was banished here by my people. There was a threat to my kingdom, but I was- I was forced to leave before I could help.

ALEX

So, you are a real knight?

DAMIEN

I- I was. No longer.

ALEX

Do you want to go back?

DAMIEN

I can't. I was sent here with irreversible magic. I'm destined to live out my days in this new world.

CORY

Do you guys have coke in your world?

Damien stares at the bubbling carbonation coming from the top of the glass of soda.

DAMIEN

We have potions that resemble this.

CORY

Weird.

ALEX

This place is called America.

DAMIEN

What is that?

ALEX

Um, we have food with lots of sugar in it. And, lots of different people who do all kinds of things.

CORY

There's also shows for everything, even knights!

DAMIEN

Strange.

ALEX

I have this book that, well here.

Alex hands Damien the fairytale book with a knight and dragon on the cover.

Damien flips through the pages seeing images of a kingdom, battles, and triumph. He puts it down after seeing the ending.

ALEX (CONT'D)
Everything I know about your world
I learned in that book.

DAMIEN
That's nothing like my world.

ALEX
That doesn't matter. I know you're
not a knight anymore, but you act
like one. That's good enough for
me.

Damien hears this, and gets up.

DAMIEN
I should go.

ALEX
Where?

DAMIEN
I'll find shelter somewhere.

ALEX
But, you can stay here! Right,
Cory?

CORY
Uhhhh...

ALEX
Just stay with us. We can keep you
safe, and teach you about the
world. Plus, Cory has endless food
here.

CORY
My mom goes to the grocery a lot.

DAMIEN
This is... acceptable. Thank you
for your generosity.

ALEX
Of course! On one condition.

DAMIEN
I'm sorry? Generosity is supposed
to be-

ALEX
Ya whatever. I need you to come to
school with me tomorrow.

DAMIEN
I've already taken all three
classes, why would I go to school
with you?

CORY
Huh?

ALEX
I need you to be a knight.

Damien goes to protest, but starts to yawn.

DAMIEN
What have you done to me. I've
fallen drowsy.

Damien retires to the couch.

ALEX
That's the food with lots of sugar
in it.

DAMIEN
This is despicable. We'll talk
about this in the mornin-

Damien dozes off before he can finish protesting.

CORY
What now?

ALEX
Sleep. Tomorrow, we're going to
meet a knight!

INT. CORY'S HOUSE - CORY'S BASEMENT - NEXT MORNING

Alex is woken up by Cory shaking her.

CORY
Alex! He's gone!

ALEX
Who? Damien's gone?

CORY
He wasn't here when I woke up!

ALEX
Okay, wait, let's figure this out.
He could maybe be back at the gas
station.

CORY
Or he just ran off into the woods!

ALEX
Why would he do that? Maybe he's
looking for something, we should
check the backyard again.

CORY
Maybe he went looking for a
bathroom and got lost.

ALEX
Cory, be serious!

CORY
I'm trying!

ALEX
Okay, I'll search the gas station,
and you check the backyard. Got it?

CORY
Got it!

Just then, a LOUD SCREAM comes from upstairs.

MS. ALEXANDER (O.S.)
AHHHHHHHHH!!!

ALEX
Uh oh.

The two rush upstairs.

INT. CORY'S HOUSE - CORY'S KITCHEN - CONTINUOUS

Damien stands in the middle of the fridge rummaging through
all the food, unbothered by the person he just frightened.

Cory and Alex rush into explain.

CORY
Hey Mom!

MS. ALEXANDER, (30s), Cory's Mom who's just as honest as the next person stands waiting for an explanation.

MS. ALEXANDER
Who the hell is in our kitchen!

ALEX
That would be my dad!

MS. ALEXANDER
What?

DAMIEN
(mouthing)
What?

ALEX
He's just dressed up for school.
He's coming with us today to do a
presentation on acting in fairy
tales.

MS. ALEXANDER
Oh my god, I'm so sorry. I forgot
that you have new guardians, Alex.
It's a pleasure to meet you.

Ms. Alexander sticks out a hand to Damien. Damien grabs it
and kisses it.

DAMIEN
The pleasure is all mine, fair
lady.

MS. ALEXANDER
Oh! How sweet, he stays in
character.
(giggles)
Cory, next time try and give me a
heads up when we have guests in the
house before I wake up.

CORY
Yup, sorry mom.

MS. ALEXANDER
So, why don't we all go together. I
can drive us, and get to know your
foster dad a little better. What do
you say?

ALEX
Sound great! We'll be ready in
fifteen.

MS. ALEXANDER
Perfect, I'll start the car.

Ms. Alexander exits.

CORY
Wow that was close. Did you find
the bathroom, mister knight?

DAMIEN
What is happening right now?

ALEX
I'll explain in the car, we're
going to school!

DAMIEN
What's a car?!

INT. MS. ALEXANDER'S CAR - MOMENTS LATER

Cory sits with his mom in the front seat, while Alex sits
with Damien, whose helmet is in his lap, in the back.

DAMIEN
So, we're inside a horse?

ALEX
No, no, it's a machine that's
really fast, like a horse. Like a
hundred horses I think.

DAMIEN
Impressive.

ALEX
Let's talk about your presentation.
All you need to do is go up there
and tell stories of battles you've
had or any of the training you've
had just make sure to say you're
just pretending.

DAMIEN
But, I wasn't just pretending.

ALEX
No, of course not, but that's too
unbelievable. Just lie a little,
cool?

DAMIEN

If I must. I'm worried my words
will fumble.

ALEX

You'll be great! Everyone's going
to love hearing your stories, it's
like you're a superhero.

DAMIEN

And what's that?

ALEX

Don't worry about it. Do this for
me, and you'll save my life. You'll
be my hero.

Damien perks up at this, and takes a deep breath.

DAMIEN

Then it is done.

EXT. SCHOOL PARKING LOT - SAME TIME

The car pulls into a parking space, and everyone but Damien
gets out.

MS. ALEXANDER

Is your he okay in there?

ALEX

Um, yeah, I think he's just fixing
his suit.

MS. ALEXANDER

Oh no worries, why don't you stay
with him then. I'm going to walk
Cory in. See you inside!

Cory and his mom walk off.

I/E. CAR - SAME TIME

Alex looks through the open backseat door at Damien who sits
frozen staring at his helmet.

ALEX

Are you okay?

DAMIEN

Give me a moment. Shut the door, if
you will.

ALEX
Alright, just hurry up please, I
don't want to be late.

Damien nods.

EXT. SCHOOL PARKING LOT - SAME TIME

Alex shuts the door with an anxious sigh.

She walks to the back of the car and sets her backpack on the
hood of the trunk, then opens it and starts rummaging
through.

JACK (O.S.)
Hey, Loser!

Alex whirls around to see Jack approaching.

JACK (CONT'D)
Were you looking for parents in
there?

ALEX
How do I even respond to that?
Obviously, no.

JACK
Well, I wasn't really asking. Had
to make sure you were alone.

ALEX
I-

Damien finally comes out of the car, full suit of armor on,
and joins Alex outside.

DAMIEN
I'm ready. Who's this, a friend of
yours?

Jack instantly shuts up.

ALEX
This, Dad, is my classmate, Jack.

DAMIEN
Ah, you look small for your age.

JACK
Sorry.

JACK'S DAD (O.S.)
Jack! Stop wasting your time!

Without another word, Jack runs off.

DAMIEN
Do I have to pretend to be your dad
too?

ALEX
If it's all the same to you?

Alex smiles up at him, almost pleading.

DAMIEN
I'll adjust.

Alex rejoices and grabs her backpack off the hood of the trunk.

A storybook falls out of the bag, but Alex and Damien walk on without noticing.

The storybook with Damien on the cover lies on the road abandoned.

INT. SCHOOL - ENTRANCE - MOMENTS LATER

Alex and Damien walk up to a check-in desk for parents.

Two faculty members sit behind the desk to greet people.

FACULTY #1
Student's name?

ALEX
Alex, and this is my
guardian/foster dad.

FACULTY #2
We have a foster mom under your
name. Is Tess here?

ALEX
She couldn't make it, this is her
husband.

FACULTY #2
I'm not sure we're allowed to
accept changes this late.

FACULTY #1

Oh, c'mon, they've got a full suit of armor are you really going to throw the book at them.

FACULTY #2

Any identification?

ALEX

Well-

Ms. Lily appears to save the day.

MS. LILY

Alex I'm so glad you're here! And I presume this is your father whom I've yet to meet.

ALEX

(nervously)

Yup, this is him.

DAMIEN

(sticks out a hand)

How do you do, m'lady?

MS. LILY

Oh, wow, I love the character! It's very nice to meet you. Hopefully we can become acquainted outside of your act after the presentations, but you guys should get inside, because we're starting soon.

Ms. Lily ushers them past the desk, and inside the classroom.

INT. SCHOOL - HOME ROOM - SAME TIME

All the students are at their desks, and there's a line of parents at the front of the class.

ALEX

(to Damien)

That's where you go, I think.

DAMIEN

I'm not sure I'm ready.

ALEX

Just remember what we talked about, and you're going to be great. If you really need help, you can read from one of my storybooks, one sec.

Alex searches her backpack for the book with Damien on the cover, but has trouble finding it.

She begins to worry, but too late as the Ms. Lily enters the room.

MS. LILY

Alright, ladies, gentleman, and students! If all the parents can come up to the front of the class, I think we can start out presentations.

ALEX

(to Damien)

I can't find it right now, it's okay. Go up and be yourself!

Damien goes to the front, and Alex settles in her chair.

She breathes through a wave of worry, and lets excitement wash over as she waits for Damien's presentation.

INT. SCHOOL - HOME ROOM - AFTER SOME PRESENTATIONS

Ms. Alexander stands in front of the class finishing her presentation.

MS. ALEXANDER

It can definitely be hard operating on someone, because you have to be very focused. You do get to use tools, which can be fun.

She holds up two metal pointy things.

MS. ALEXANDER (CONT'D)

These things are what allow me to help people see better. Don't worry though, if those look boring to you, I also get to use lasers!

The classroom gasps and applauds as Ms. Alexander walks off.

MS. LILY

Thank you so much for that amazing presentation on Optometry. Next up, we have Alex's foster dad!

Ms. Lily holds out a hand, gesturing to Damien as she walks off.

Light applause as Damien walks in front of the students.

DAMIEN
Good day, children. I am Alex's...
(eyes alex)
Father. I am a Knight. I am part of
King Meras's army, and I fight to
protect...

He trails off losing sense of what he's saying. A silence
falls over the room.

MS. LILY
If anyone has questions, feel free
to ask.

STUDENT #1
Do you have a sword?

DAMIEN
I have a sword, and a shield. They
are not with me.

STUDENT #2
Is your armor even real? It looks
fake.

DAMIEN
Of course, it can withstand the
flames of a dragon.

JACK
Have you killed any dragons?

DAMIEN
I- yes, I've bested many creatures.

CORY
Where do the other knights live?
And King Meras? What's he up to?

Damien falters on this question. He tries to find words, but
nothing comes out.

DAMIEN
I'm sorry, Alex.

Damien panics and rushes out of the classroom, and Alex runs
out after him.

Ms. Lily walks back to the front of the classroom, awkwardly.

MS. LILY
That concludes our presentations.
Time for lunch.

The bell rings, and everyone gets up.

INT. SCHOOL - HALLWAY - CONTINUOUS

Alex finds Damien halfway down the hallway and calls out to him.

ALEX
Wait! Don't go!

Damien collapses against a wall of lockers, breathing heavily.

Alex rushes up to him.

ALEX (CONT'D)
Are you okay? What's going on?

DAMIEN
My heart--

The panic cuts him off.

Alex looks around for help, but there's nothing.

ALEX
Take off your armor, maybe it'll
make you feel better.

She reaches for the chest-piece to help him, but Damien stops her hand.

DAMIEN
Don't. It's all I have.

He lets go of her hand, but she holds onto his wrist and checks his pulse.

She feels it racing, and moves to a hug to try and comfort him.

The rise and fall of Damien's chest slows down until he's able to talk.

DAMIEN (CONT'D)
Thank you. I have no idea what
happened. Something must've set me
off, this isn't normal for me.

ALEX
You think? I bet you're just
hungry.

DAMIEN
(he chuckles)
That's a wise wager.

ALEX
It's time for lunch, let's go.

Alex helps Damien up and they walk off.

INT. SCHOOL - CAFETERIA - MOMENTS LATER

Alex and Damien bring trays a food to a table where Cory and his mom are already eating.

CORY
Hey guys! Is everything okay,
mister knight?

ALEX
We're all good, classic case of the
urgent bathroom break in a suit of
armor. You know how that goes.

CORY
Sure.

MS. ALEXANDER
Did you guys get any of the
lasagna? It's really good.

ALEX
It was done when we got there. They
put chicken tenders on my plate
without asking.

DAMIEN
I got the balls of meat.

MS. ALEXANDER
Yum! Well, dig in.

They all chow down before at their table.

MS. ALEXANDER (CONT'D)
Does anyone want more bread? I
think I'm going to go get some.

DAMIEN
Bread? Fresh bread? I haven't had a
home grown loaf in ages. I shall
accompany you to them.

MS. ALEXANDER
Be my guest.

They walk off together.

After the two leave, Jack and the bullies approach.

JACK
Hey, great presentation over there.
I really loved the part where your
"dad" ran out of the room crying.

The bullies laugh.

JACK (CONT'D)
Is he even your real dad?

ALEX
He is.

CORY
This is none of your business
anyway, Jack, leave us alone.

JACK
I always make bullying you guys my
business.

ALEX
It's not like your dad's
presentation was any better. Who
wants to be a business man.

JACK
Anyone who wants to be rich, and
not a poor orphan, like you.

CHASE
Yeah, I want to be rich.

ETHAN
Hey, is that your dad's helmet?

Ethan points out the helmet sitting in Damien's seat.

CORY
Leave us alone.

Jack snatches the helmet before Alex can.

ALEX
Give that back right now!

JACK

Or what?

DAMIEN

Or I shall unleash upon you the
wrath of a thousand dark elves!

The bullies turn to face Damien towering over them.

CHASE

I'm sorry, sir.

ETHAN

Stop talking.

DAMIEN

Return my helmet at once.

Jack sheepishly hands its over.

Suddenly, Jack's father, DON GARDNER (late 30s), brooding and
entitled, enters the fray.

DON GARDNER

What's going on here?! Give that
back to my son.

DAMIEN

I'll have you know, good sir, that
your son tried to take something
that wasn't his. I merely took back
my property.

DON GARDNER

Looks to me that you physically
assaulted him in the process.

DAMIEN

You must be the town jester. Or the
town fool. Which is it, Alex?

DON GARDNER

I'll have words with the principal
about this.

DAMIEN

A look at your principals would be
advised. I hope your son could
learn a thing or two.

DON GARDNER

Let's go, Jack. We're going home,
you're getting extra chores today.

JACK
I'm sorry, dad, can I have another
chance, please?

DON GARDNER
We're leaving, no discussion.

Jack hangs his head in silence as he leaves with his dad. The bullies follow suit, and leave the scene.

Damien returns to their table with Alex and Cory.

CORY
You saved our butts, mister knight,
thank you!

ALEX
That was awesome, seriously.

DAMIEN
All in a day's work. It's not hard
to put someone in their place.

Damien shares a smile with Alex, then pulls out three loafs of bread that he was carrying.

INT. CORY'S HOUSE - CORY'S BASEMENT - LATER

Everyone retires to the basement where they all started the day.

ALEX
Thank you for what you did today.

DAMIEN
It was nothing, merely the
honorable thing to do.

ALEX
Still, it I appreciate you being
there for me, I'm kind of short on
that kind of thing.

There's a moment of silence as the two settle into this new side of their relationship.

ALEX (CONT'D)
You wouldn't stick around any
longer, would you?

DAMIEN
I don't quite understand what you
mean.

ALEX

You need a place to stay.. stay here, stay with us.

DAMIEN

I couldn't do that.

ALEX

Why not? We can give you shelter and food and you can give us-

CORY

A Friend!!!

ALEX

(laughing)

Exactly.

Damien takes a moment to consider the proposition.

DAMIEN

And you're sure I wouldn't be a burden?

ALEX

Burden? I just had the best school day of my life pretending you were my dad, you would be more like a gift.

DAMIEN

That's very kind of you, child. I'm afraid I'd only get in your way, and I have no business interjecting in the life of a youth whilst I've yet to follow my own path.

(he hesitates) I used to be a knight, and I'm no longer what I was meant to be. Until I find my way back to who that was, I'm not sure I can do anything else. I hope you'll understand.

ALEX

Wait, listen, I get it. I understand you've got this mission, and you're trying to find out who you are but-I don't need a knight, I just need you to be my guardian. I'm asking you, please, do this for me before you go - just a couple of days.

CORY
Please, Mr. Knight?

DAMIEN
If you need me that bad, then I'm
there for you.

ALEX
Yes! Thank you, thank you, thank
you! You're not going to regret
this, we're going to have a ton of
fun!

DAMIEN

I should hope so.

ALEX
Alright guys, let's get some sleep,
because tomorrow we're doing it all
over again!

With that, they all shut the lights and get ready for bed.

CORY
Goodnight everyone!

ALEX
Goodnight!

DAMIEN
Good night, good night, parting is
such sweet sorrow that I shall say
good night till it be morrow.

INT. SCHOOL - HALLWAY - THE NEXT DAY

Just like the entrance of your favorite football team, Alex
strides through the hallway as Damien escorts her to the
classroom.

Students and teachers' heads turn in awe of the figure of the
walking their halls, Alex can feel her "cool points" rising.

The two pass the band of bullies, and Damien stares Jack down
in his eyes as they're passing. The group literally cowers in
fear.

Alex enjoys the new status she's gained with Damien by her
side and she unapologetically shows it.

EXT. SCHOOL - ENTRANCE - END OF SCHOOL DAY

Alex comes out of the schools doors as she's leaving and locks eyes with Damien who's waiting for her at the bottom of the steps.

Alex practically skips down the steps in excitement.

When she reaches Damien, she jumps into a hug.

ALEX

Best day! That was the best day!

DAMIEN

What happened?

ALEX

MY DAD IS A KNIGHT! Everyone in my class thinks I'm the coolest person ever, I mean except jack and his friends obviously, but they tried to mess with me at lunch again and-

DAMIEN

If that wretched creature even breathed on you-

ALEX

Oh he wishes; I'm so popular now, everyone wants to sit next to me at lunch, and I've got like a force field of friends! It's amazing!

DAMIEN

Thats incredible. Did Cory enjoy the same benefits?

ALEX

He was there too, I think. I didn't actually see him a whole lot today because so many people wanted to talk to me. Oh man, what a great day. Aren't you excited?

DAMIEN

I'm not sure what to expect.

ALEX

Do you trust me?

DAMIEN

I'm not sure of that either.

ALEX

Hey?!

DAMIEN

Kidding!

ALEX

Aw, c'mon. Let's just go to the mall.

I/E. FOSTER HOME - SAME TIME

Tess watches from the front door as the school-bus comes to a stop at their driveway.

The bus doors open and Tess' foster kids come down the stairs and into the house.

She greets and hugs all of them, making sure they're all safely inside while keeping count on one hand.

After the bus doors close and the bus drives away, Tess realizes she's one short and becomes worried.

INT. FOSTER HOME - KITCHEN - MOMENTS LATER

Tess grabs a home phone and dials.

MRS. HOBBS, (50s), the absent minded school secretary, picks up the phone.

MRS. HOBBS (V.O.)

Pizan Elementary, Mrs. Hobbs speaking.

TESS

Hi, Delores. My kids just got home from school, but Alex didn't get off the bus, so I just wanted to make sure she's still at school.

MRS. HOBBS (V.O.)

Give me a moment, I'll check our sign-in sheet.

The line goes silent as Tess waits for her answers.

MRS. HOBBS

So, what I have here is that Alex was checked out by her foster dad/guardian.

TESS

But, I'm her guardian. What do you mean foster dad?

MRS. HOBBS (V.O.)

I presume your husband.

TESS

Delores, my husband hasn't been to the school once in the last three years, who has my kid?

MRS. HOBBS (V.O.)

I'm so sorry, let me connect you with Ms. Lily right away.

TESS

You bet your ass you'll connect me!

The line cuts and Tess is put on hold. Her scream echoes over the waiting music.

Finally, the line picks up again.

MS. LILY (V.O.)

Hello, Tess?

TESS

Hi, Ms. Lily, hope you're day is going well, because mine just got horrible. Who is Mr. Smith?

MS. LILY (V.O.)

Pardon me?

TESS

I just spoke on the phone with Mrs. Hobbs because Alex didn't get on the bus today, and she said that a Mr. Smith marked as her guardian - *definitely not my husband* - signed her out, and you're supposed to be her teacher so tell me where my child is!

MS. LILY (V.O.)

(stammers)

Of course, I - I don't know what to say. I only just met your husband the other day-

TESS

MY HUSBAND HAS NEVER BEEN TO PIZAN ELEMENTARY!

MS. LILY (V.O.)
I don't understand. Alex brought
someone to career day, and
introduced them as her new foster
dad.

TESS
Whoever that was kidnapped my
child. You need to find them and
get Alex back.

MS. LILY (V.O.)
I'll contact the police right away.

EXT. MALL PARKING LOT - LATER

Alex, Damien, Cory, and Ms. Alexander get out of the car.

ALEX
Thanks for driving us again!

MS. ALEXANDER
Of course! You kids keep growing so
I need a new wardrobe for Cory
anyway.

CORY
Wait what, but I love my clothes.

MS. ALEXANDER
It's not my fault you're growing so
fast.

CORY
You're the one that keeps making me
drink milk!

MS. ALEXANDER
(she laughs)
I guess that's true.

They all start walking toward the entrance.

DAMIEN
You mean for me to believe, the
entirety of this structure is one
large market.

ALEX
Yeah, pretty much. Think of
anything you want, and we'll find
it in there.

DAMIEN
The economy must be thriving.

MS. ALEXANDER
Don't even get me started.

INT. MALL ENTRANCE - MOMENT'S LATER

The group comes to a fork and stops to plan what they'll do.

ALEX
Would it be okay if me and Damien
go to some stores on our own?

MS. ALEXANDER
I don't see why not. Me and Cory
are going to need some time in the
fitting rooms. Why don't we meet
back here when we're all done? Say
in an hour or two?

ALEX
Sounds great! Off we go then.

CORY
See ya later!

Cory and his mom walk off, and Alex turns to Damien.

ALEX
Ready?

DAMIEN
For what exactly?

ALEX
We're getting you a new costume.

DAMIEN
I like my costume- my armor. It's
armor. I can't take off my armor.

ALEX
Why not?

DAMIEN
Doesn't feel right. I...

ALEX
Let's just try it. That's what
fitting rooms are for!

DAMIEN

Where are we even going to put my armor?

ALEX

I'll ask for a bag.

DAMIEN

They provide these free of charge?

ALEX

Yeah, I'll ask for a big one. Stop asking questions, you're wasting time.

DAMIEN

But-

ALEX

Nope. You're trying on clothes, let's go.

Damien sighs as Alex starts walking, and he begrudgingly follows.

INT. MALL - CONTINUOUS - MONTAGE

Alex and Damien go to different stores and Damien tries on outfits as they look for something that fits him.

- HUGO BOSS:

Damien tries on a full suit and tie, and Alex shakes her head in disagreement.

- HOT TOPIC:

Alex shows Damien what graphic tees are. She makes him wear a shirt with princesses on, but he doesn't feel comfortable in it.

- LULULEMON:

Alex makes Damien try on workout leggings with a muscle-fit long sleeve shirt. Damien looks at himself in the mirror intrigued, but Alex shoots it down.

- TOMMY BAHAMA:

Damien tries on surfer attire, but then loses focus trying to use a prop surfboard as a shield. Alex makes them leave before he can do any serious damage.

- J. CREW:

Damien tries on a very preppy outfit which both of them reject immediately.

END MONTAGE

INT. MALL WALKWAY - CONTINUOUS

Damien and Alex exit the J. Crew with full armor still on and no new clothes in hand.

DAMIEN

Well that was a fantastic waste of time.

ALEX

You didn't have fun?

DAMIEN

I didn't say that, it's just--

Alex makes a sad face in attempt to guilt trip him

DAMIEN (CONT'D)

Stop with that. This is unethical, you're emotionally manipulating me.

ALEX

(still making the face)

I don't know what that means.

Damien stares stubbornly at Alex as she appears to get increasingly sad. Eventually she breaks him.

DAMIEN

FINE!

(sighs)

I had fun.

ALEX

Yay! I'm sorry we didn't get anything though.

DAMIEN

It's not easy putting on pants that never existed before, you know. I mean, it was a real struggle, in fact, I think that was the most active I've been since I got here.

ALEX
You made it look easy.

DAMIEN
Well it wasn't. And I'm hungry.

ALEX
OH MY GOD, I HAVE THE PERFECT
RESTAURANT FOR YOU!

DAMIEN
Do they have food?

ALEX
Yes, it's a restaurant, food is all
they do.

DAMIEN
Fantastic! Show me at once!

Alex and Damien round a corner to reveal-

INT. MALL - RAINFOREST CAFE ENTRANCE - CONTINUOUS

ALEX
Here it is!

DAMIEN
What in god's name are those
noises?

ALEX
Animals! This place is supposed to
be a real life Jungle!

DAMIEN
And they let you eat.. in the
Jungle? With the animals?

ALEX
YES! There's monkeys, and snakes,
and birds, and fish! They have
everything here, they even have an
Alligator!

DAMIEN
What? Where?!

ROAR!!!

An Animatronic Alligator rises out of its fake water bed and
scares Damien into jumping back.

DAMIEN (CONT'D)
This is my worst nightmare.

ALEX
(whiny)
Why? This is supposed to be
awesome!

DAMIEN
Alex, do you know what a moat is?

ALEX
Is it a cool knight thing you used
to fight dragons?

DAMIEN
Yes, except it's not cool and it
wasn't for fighting dragons. A moat
is a big river around our castle
that we have to protect us from
anyone trying to get in, and if
someone falls in the rivers we keep
Mini-Dragons to EAT THEM. And you
want to have DINNER with the Mini-
Dragons!

He points to the Alligator who settles into its water bed.

ALEX
Well, I think the Mini-Dragons are
cool.

She starts slowly making her guilt-tripping face, Damien
catches on very quickly

DAMIEN
Oh don't do that. Not again, that's
not fair.

Alex doesn't listen and continues making the face. Damien
tries to stare her down again.

All of a sudden, Damien starts sniffing the air.

ALEX
What're you doing?

He catches a scent, and turns around to follow it without a
word.

ALEX (CONT'D)
Hello? I was making sad face!

Damien walks off, leaving Alex with no choice, but to follow him.

Damien sniffs the air like a hound dog letting his smelling sense lead the way to its source.

After some turns, Damien looks up to see

INT. MALL - AUNTIE ANNE'S KIOSK - CONTINUOUS

Damien walks up to the queue, and stares at all the food ahead.

He takes deep breath as he watches workers knead dough, cook hot dogs, and baste buns with butter.

Damien moves past everyone waiting to get to the front.

Alex watches from a distance, and tries to get to Damien faster, in fear he might cause a disturbance.

Meanwhile, Damien makes it to the front while someone else is ordering, but tries to order anyway.

DAMIEN

I'd like one of these, please.

SHOP WORKER

Sir, there's a line of people who have been here longer than you. I'm going to need you to wait with them.

DAMIEN

I only request one, and then I'll be on my way.

SHOP WORKER

Sir, I can't sell anything to you at this time.

DAMIEN

What is the meaning of this?

ALEX

Damien, get over here!

Alex yanks Damien to the side.

ALEX (CONT'D)

How many times have we talked about not walking up to people you don't know without me?

DAMIEN

I only wanted their food, I was trying to better the economy.

ALEX

That doesn't matter, you don't even have money!

DAMIEN

I'll have you know, I am quite wealthy. The treasure reserve in my castle is worth more than the combined wealth of three dragons' treasure coves.

ALEX

Is that because you killed three dragons?

DAMIEN

That's not the point. I'm still hungry, and I'm doing anything else until we eat.

Damien crosses his arms and turns his back to Alex who rolls her eyes.

ALEX

If I buy you a pretzel, will you come to one last store and try an outfit on for me?

DAMIEN

(makes a thinking face)

I require two pretzels to make that happen.

ALEX

Fine two.

DAMIEN

And a beverage.

Damien turns to see why there's no reply and sees Alex already queuing. He gives a smile and relaxes.

INT. MALL - ORGANIC CLOTHES STORE ENTRANCE - MOMENTS LATER

Damien follows Alex's lead, eating with food and drink in hand.

ALEX
Okay, this is it. I think you'll
really like this stuff.

DAMIEN
(mouth full)
I don't think I'll like anything
more than I like this pretzel.

ALEX
Would you take this seriously,
please?

Damien takes a big gulp.

DAMIEN
Sorry, yes, I'm with you.

ALEX
No, no. Finish your food before we
go in.

DAMIEN
But I want to savor it, I want to-

ALEX
Finish your food.

INT. MALL - ORGANIC CLOTHES STORE - MOMENTS LATER

Alex and Damien browse the various clothes on the walls and
shelves.

DAMIEN
Am I supposed to know which of
these things will look good on me?
Because they all just look like
plants to me.

ALEX
Leave the picking to me. Last time
you chose something, I almost threw
up.

DAMIEN
Well, that's not very kind.

ALEX
Again, don't want your opinion on
this.

Damien furrows his brow, but accepts this.

Alex starts taking various pieces and handing them to Damien to hold.

DAMIEN
What is all this?

ALEX
The less you ask, the better off you are.

DAMIEN
I'm not used to people dressing me.

ALEX
You're mom doesn't pick out your clothes for you?

DAMIEN
Only when I was little, I'm grown now, I only wear my armor and my nightwear.

ALEX
Ew, doesn't that get smelly?

DAMIEN
We have servants who clean them.

ALEX
So, you don't do your own laundry? Even, I do my own laundry.

DAMIEN
I've never tried, is it fun?

ALEX
If you make it a game. I like to make outfits and wash them together. You should try it.

DAMIEN
I only have the one outfit.

ALEX
Well, that's why we're getting these.

Alex piles on one last pair of trousers.

ALEX (CONT'D)
Okay, you know the drill now. Go into the changing room and-

DAMIEN

And only put on the clothes in the order I gave them to you, yes it's been stuck in my head all day.

ALEX

Last time you're going to hear it.
Come out after every one.

Damien gives a thumbs up and heads inside.

Alex looks around the store as she waits for Damien. She gets the attention of a worker and waves them down.

ALEX (CONT'D)

Do you guys have a kids section?

WORKER

No, I'm so sorry.

ALEX

Can I ask why?

WORKER

Umm, that's just not the vibe we're going for, I guess.

Alex nods and walks away

ALEX

(to herself)

O-kayyy...

Damien comes out of the fitting room

DAMIEN

Here it is! What do you think?

ALEX

This is actually pretty nice, I like the earth tones on you.

DAMIEN

Earth tones! That's what it is! I think I just needed something more natural. I really like this.

ALEX

You look great! Does it fit okay, are you comfortable?

DAMIEN

This is the softest shirt I've ever worn.

ALEX
I'll take that as a yes. Go try on
more, I'll wait here!

DAMIEN
I will!

Damien goes back in, excited.

CUT TO:

INT. MALL ENTRANCE - SAME TIME

Where Damien and Alex once entered from, two POLICE OFFICERS
walk into the mall.

One of their radios goes off:

POLICE CHIEF (O.S.)
See if anyone recognizes them from
the photo while we contact the mall
security to make this easier. If
you see the guardian, bring him in,
and if you see the girl, ensure her
safety. Over.

We see a picture in the hands of one of the officers with
Alex's face on it.

OFFICER #1
Heard, over.

Both officers stay close together as they begin a sweep of
the mall. They periodically stop to ask people about the
picture.

INT. ORGANIC CLOTHES STORE - LATER

Damien walks out of the fitting room again, this time with a
large sweater and cotton pants.

DAMIEN
So, this is what you call cashmere?

ALEX
Yup, I don't know what it is, but
it's supposed to be nice!

DAMIEN
It's very expensive. How are we
paying for this again?

ALEX

I'm not sure, I didn't think that far ahead. Do you like it?

DAMIEN

I love it, it makes me feel like a glorified shepherd. I actually knew the richest shepherd in my kingdom, very old man, but wise! And-

Damien's voice trails as Alex is distracted by a cop she sees just outside the store.

She gets closer to the window to see what's going on and notices the officer holding up a picture.

The picture is one of her in her foster home. The officer holds up another, a picture of Damien from Career Day at the school.

Alex's face darkens as she realizes what's going on.

She backs away from the window quickly and rushes back to Damien who's still telling his story while appreciating his outfit in the mirror.

ALEX

Damien, stop talking.

DAMIEN

When did you get so rude?

ALEX

No, seriously, look outside.

Damien looks and sees the officers.

ALEX (CONT'D)

I saw them showing our picture to people. I think they want to arrest us.

DAMIEN

We'll hide then, surely they'll leave if they don't find us. C'mon let's get out of here.

ALEX

Wait, hold on!

Damien walks straight past the exit and-

INT. MALL - ORGANIC CLOTHES STORE ENTRANCE - CONTINUOUS

BLAAAAAREEEEE!

Damien makes it one step outside the store before setting off the theft alarms with the new clothes he's wearing.

He turns to Alex, horrified.

DAMIEN
What did I do?!

ALEX
You left the store without paying
for the clothes!

Just then, officers in the vicinity take notice of the blaring alarm, and finally spot Alex and Damien.

DAMIEN
What do we do?

Alex joins him outside, as the officers close in.

ALEX
Don't freak out, we can explain
this. If we do anything crazy, then
they'll think we're bad people, so
just be cool.

DAMIEN
Alex, I don't think I can just
stand here. I'm not going to jail.

Damien looks at the surrounding police and begins to panic.

DAMIEN (CONT'D)
I'm sorry, Alex. Just get home
safely, I'll find you later.

ALEX
Damien, you don't know what you're
doing. Stay with me, I can help
you!

Damien doesn't listen, and starts running away.

At the same time, an officer reaches Alex and keeps her from going anywhere.

OFFICER #2
Stay right here, Alex. We're taking
you home.
(into radio)
(MORE)

OFFICER #2 (CONT'D)
 Suspect is on the move and
 panicked. He's near the west exit
 of the mall, proceed with caution.

INT. MALL - WEST EXIT - CONTINUOUS

Damien runs without direction, until he sees a big red EXIT
 sign ahead.

He keeps his head down, breathing heavy, and unaware of
 anything around him.

Before he can reach the doors, three police officers
 intercept him.

OFFICER #1
 That's enough, you're under arrest.

The officers restrain him, and they start putting him in
 handcuffs.

DAMIEN
 I don't want any trouble, please
 just let me leave. I don't want to
 be here.

OFFICER #1
 Then you shouldn't've been here in
 the first place.

Damien stops struggling and melts into the reality of his new
 situation.

The officers walk him out of the mall as the public looks on.

EXT. FOSTER HOME - FRONT DOOR - LATER

Alex waits at the doorstep with a police officer, until Tess
 opens the door.

TESS
 Oh my god, Alex, are you okay?

ALEX
 I'm fine, nothing happened, really.

TESS
 Just get inside right now, we'll
 talk about this later.

Alex doesn't fight and goes inside.

TESS (CONT'D)
Thank you so much, officer.

OFFICER #1
Of course. Is there anything else,
ma'am?

TESS
Did you find the man she was with?

OFFICER #1
Yes, we found the suspect at the
mall with her, and he's in our
custody at the moment.

TESS
Did he say why he took her?

OFFICER #1
No, but he didn't seem aggressive,
truthfully. You might want to talk
to the young lady about what they
were doing.

TESS
Thank you, officer.

OFFICER #1
Have a good day.

INT. FOSTER HOME - ALEX'S BEDROOM - CONTINUOUS

Tess follows Alex into her bedroom, where all the other
foster kids already are.

Alex tries to climb into bed without saying a word.

TESS
Alex, are we going to talk about
this, today?

ALEX
Do we have to?

TESS
Yes, we do! You've been living with
a stranger for the past couple
days, what were you thinking!

ALEX
He was a friend.

TESS

Alex, you can't make friends with just everyone. They could be criminals, or worse.

ALEX

It's not like I go to school with people who are much better! I was friends with him, because he wanted to be friends with me!

TESS

Honey, I'm not trying to fight you here, but you know what you did was incredibly dangerous, right?

ALEX

I don't care. I wasn't being stupid, I knew he was good. He was a good person, that's all! I don't know why I can't just have friends who are good! Everyone else sucks! All they care about is themselves, and they're super boring. No one is ever imaginative like I am, and if they are they get bullied, and no one is friends with them! I just felt like I fit it in for once, and someone actually liked the same things I did and didn't hate me for them.

TESS

Alex, we all love you here, none of us would bully you.

ALEX

Tess, you have nothing to say, at least he came to school with me! He pretended to be my dad, because he actually cared about me and he wanted me to have someone there for me - he wanted me to have someone who cared about me, because he really did care about me unlike you!

TESS

You are out of line, Alex. I-

ALEX

You don't do anything for me! You don't care about who I am.

(MORE)

ALEX (CONT'D)

All I want is someone who cares
about me, but you're not there for
me!

Alex's pleas turn into sobs and she can no longer speak.

The room is quiet except for Alex.

Tess slowly makes her way to the edge of her bed, and picks
her up. She walks out of the room with her in her arms.

INT. FOSTER HOME - TESS' BEDROOM

Tess lays Alex down on her bed.

Alex is still, with her head in her hands, still quietly
crying.

TESS

Listen, darling. You're feeling
hurt, and alone, I get that. I need
you to know that I love you, and I
only want what's best for you. I'm
sorry if I made you feel like
anything else was true. I just need
you to trust me.

ALEX

Why would I trust you? I don't even
know you.

TESS

I know we just met... but I really
feel like you're my daughter. I've
never been able to have kids, but
I've always loved them, and anyone
who lives under this roof is a
child of mine. I would do anything
for you, you have to believe me.

ALEX

Can we get Damien back?

TESS

Is that your friend's name? Kind of
old fashioned, don't you think?

She tries for humor; it misses.

ALEX

He's not from around here.

TESS

I guess that makes sense, because Ms. Alexander told me he spoke sort of weird.

ALEX

You talked to Ms. Alexander?

TESS

We spoke after the police called about you. Cory's safe with her, they were just surprised to hear Damien wasn't your real foster dad.

ALEX

He got along with them. He was super nice to everyone, he really was a good person.

TESS

I know, baby, but you never see every side of a person right when you meet them. Anyway, don't worry about him for right now, the police are still processing him.

ALEX

What do you mean?

TESS

They're holding him down at the station just to be safe.

ALEX

Are they going to hurt them? Tess, you have to tell them he's innocent.

TESS

Alex, I've never met him, I don't even know if that's true.

Alex's head whips upright.

ALEX

You don't believe me?!

Tess pauses to rephrase herself.

TESS

I believe you, honey, I'm just playing it safe.

(MORE)

TESS (CONT'D)

We can go down to the station to see him together in the morning. I think you should get some rest for now.

ALEX

Promise me we'll go tomorrow.

TESS

I promise, Alex. Just me and you, we'll go together.

Alex relaxes with this.

TESS (CONT'D)

Alright, you've had a long day, let me tuck you in.

ALEX

Wait, can I have my bag?

TESS

Sure, I'll be right back.

Tess leaves to retrieve the bag.

Alex gets out of bed, and walks over to a nearby standing mirror.

She looks at herself, almost confused at what's looking back at her.

Tess re-enters, bag in hand.

TESS (CONT'D)

Here you go. Don't stay up too late, though.

Alex climbs into the bed, and Tess hands her the bag.

ALEX

I won't.

TESS

Promise?

She adds a kind smile, and Alex manages a weak one back.

ALEX

Promise. Good night.

TESS

Sleep tight.

Tess leaves, and Alex lays down for a moment.

She stares at the ceiling for a couple seconds, then sits back up and opens her bag.

Alex rummages through her books to find her favorite one, but has some trouble.

She starts pulling out everything she has in the bag, and placing it on the bed in front of her.

She reaches in one more time to feel for anything missing, but feels nothing. When she pulls out her hand though, she realizes her hand has become INVISIBLE.

Alex lets out a YELP!

She immediately tries to cover her mouth, and not draw attention, but Tess comes barreling in.

TESS (CONT'D)
Is everything okay?

Tess is met with a blank stare.

Alex looks down at her hand on her mouth only to realize there's nothing there.

ALEX
Oh, um, fine. I think I lost one of my books.

TESS
Can you wait till tomorrow for us to look for it, or is it going to be a problem right now?

ALEX
I can wait, sorry, I was just a little shocked. I don't know how I lost it.

TESS
Alright, if you need me, I'm a shout away.

She tries to keep it lighthearted.

Alex laughs to mask her fear, and keep Tess unsuspecting.

She succeeds, and Tess leaves again.

Alex lets go of her mouth and her eyes go wide.

ALEX
(to herself)
What is happening to me? Am I a
superhero now? Am I a ghost?!

She reaches for a book, checking if her hand will move through it, but she picks it up successfully.

ALEX (CONT'D)
Whew, not a ghost.

She randomly waves different body parts around to see if something happens, but nothing does.

She then looks around for a moment, and shuts her eyes as hard as she can.

She gives all the effort she can, scrunching her face, and OPEN!

Nothing happens.

ALEX (CONT'D)
Not a superhero either. Weird.

She falls back into bed, once again staring at the ceiling.

ALEX (CONT'D)
Cory can help, he'd know what to do.

After a few moments of tossing and turning, she passes out.

INT. BUS - NEXT MORNING

Alex climbs onto the bus and starts down the aisle.

She spots Cory who waves to her, but she doesn't return the wave.

She plops down next to Cory, making sure to hide her hand in her bag.

CORY
Good morning! Sorry about what happened yesterday. My mom was pretty pissed, I can't imagine what Tess said. Did you get grounded?

ALEX
No, Tess was nice. Something else happened.

CORY

Were the other kids mean to you?
There's just jerks, you know.

ALEX

I didn't talk to anyone else. Have
you seen the book with the knight
on it?

CORY

Not since you brought it to school
last week.

ALEX

I can't find it. I wanted to read
it last night, but then...

She trails off, trying to find the words for this next part.

CORY

Did you look under your bed?
Sometimes they fall.

ALEX

I don't think it fell, Cory. Just,
look inside my bag.

CORY

I thought you said you already
looked in your bag-

ALEX

Just look inside my bag, Cory.

Cory makes a weird face, but leans in anyway.

He slowly opens her bag, and looks inside...

CORY

OH MY GOD! WHAT HAPPENED?!!!

ALEX

SHHHHHHHHHHH!!!!!!

(whispered)

I DON'T KNOW! I think I have super
powers or something!

CORY

Does it hurt?

ALEX

Not really, I can't feel it, my
hand feels normal.

CORY
Can I touch it?

ALEX
Open your hand.

He does, and Alex gives him a high-five.

CORY
Ewww.

ALEX
EW??

CORY
That felt weird.

ALEX
No it didn't, cut it out!

CORY
Yeah, it didn't.

They both laugh.

ALEX
I don't know what to do with this,
Cory.

CORY
I think we should wait and see what
happens.

ALEX
You think something's going to
happen?

CORY
I don't know, I think we should
wait and see. Can you come over
after school, today?

ALEX
Only if your mom calls Tess.

CORY
Yeah, I'll tell her.

ALEX
Alright, we have to make a plan
tonight.

CORY
This is so cool!

ALEX

You're not the one with the
invisible hand, this is scary!

CORY

This is the coolest thing that's
ever happened to us!

ALEX

(unimpressed)

We just met a real life knight.

CORY

Oh yeah. Is Damien okay?

ALEX

He's with the police right now, but
Tess said she'd take me to see him
today. Actually, why don't you ask
your mom if you can come with us?

CORY

I'll try. I bet Damien knows what's
happening with your hand.

ALEX

But, Tess doesn't, and I don't want
to tell her yet. Let's just figure
out what we can by ourselves for
now.

Beat, then, suddenly:

CORY

I can't believe I'm friends with a
knight and a superhero!

EXT. CORY'S HOUSE - FRONT LAWN - AFTER SCHOOL

Tess and Alex wait in a car parked in front of Cory's house.

TESS

Remember what we talked about, stay
with me the whole time, and when I
say it's time to go, we have to go.

ALEX

I know, I will.

TESS

Even if Cory wants to stay, I need
you to trust me.

Before Alex can reply, the front door opens.

Ms. Alexander helps Cory with his jacket in the doorway.

When she's done, Cory jumps down the steps and runs to the car.

MS. ALEXANDER
Behave Cory, and listen to Tess!

Cory jumps into the back with Alex.

CORY
Hey guys! Thanks for taking me with you!

TESS
Of course, are you guys buckled up.

They put their seatbelts on.

TESS (CONT'D)
Alright, let's get this show on the road.

MS. ALEXANDER
Drive safe!

TESS
Be back before dinner!

The car pulls out, and they're off.

INT. COUNTY JAIL - MOMENTS LATER

Cory and Alex, followed by Tess, walk into the station.

Damien is in a small holding cell behind the front desk, unaware of his visitors.

The trio is greeted by the STATION OFFICER, (30s), who's just doing his job.

STATION OFFICER
Good evening, folks. How can I help you?

TESS
We're actually here to see the person you're holding.

This catches Damien's attention.

DAMIEN

Alex?

ALEX

Hi, Damien! Are you okay?

DAMIEN

I'm fine. Just been trying to calm myself down since I got here.

CORY

We're going to get you out of here, don't worry!

TESS

Guys, let me talk to the officer.

STATION OFFICER

We've posted bail at four hundred dollars, if you're interested ma'am.

TESS

I'm not sure about that just yet.

ALEX

Tess, we have to get Damien out, you're not going to just let him sit there, are you?

TESS

I haven't made up my mind yet, Alex, just give me a minute.

(to the officer)

Officer, can I have a word, privately?

STATION OFFICER

Certainly.

The two step off to the side.

TESS

My daughter feels very strongly about this man, she feels like he's her friend. She already has trouble making friends at school, and she won't stop telling me about all the fun she has with him.

STATION OFFICER

I understand.

TESS

I want to do everything in my power, as a mother, to make my daughter happy, but after everything that happened, I don't know if I feel comfortable letting her spend time with this man.

Tess takes a hard swallow, and settles her nerves.

TESS (CONT'D)

I just need you to tell me, from the report on the incident, does he seem like a good person?

The officer looks a little startled by the question.

STATION OFFICER

I'm not sure how to answer that question. There was no violence of any kind reported, and Alex didn't seem to want to leave his side. The only aggressive act committed was the way he fled from the scene, but even when our officers caught up to him, he left with them willingly.

Tess takes this in.

TESS

You said four hundred?

STATION OFFICER

Yes.

There's a moment where her expression seems resolved, but like she can't believe the decision she's made.

TESS

Do you take American Express?

CUT TO:

INT. CORY'S HOUSE - CORY'S BASEMENT - LATER

Everyone, including Tess and Ms. Alexander, make their way down the stairs.

MS. ALEXANDER

Why don't you take a seat on the couch.

TESS
Alex, one seat apart.

Alex sighs. She sits on the left corner cushion, and Cory sits next to her.

DAMIEN
Would it be possible for me to have
the corner seat? I've grown quite
fond of it.

He stares, sheepish, at Tess and Ms. Alexander who give no sympathy.

He reluctantly sits on the right side of the couch instead.

DAMIEN (CONT'D)
Nevermind that.

TESS
Okay, listen up people. This is new
for me, and it is still very weird.
So, we're going to establish some
ground rules.

MS. ALEXANDER
What Tess says goes the same for
me. That means you have two moms,
Cory. You hear?

CORY
Yes, mom.

TESS
Good.

MS. ALEXANDER
I think he was talking to me.

TESS
I know, I was just- whatever. Can I
take the lead?

MS. ALEXANDER
Go right ahead.

Ms. Alexander takes a step back, leaving Tess to take charge.

TESS
Okay, first thing's first-

DAMIEN
Wait, I have a question.

TESS
No questions.

CORY
But, what if I need to ask
something?

TESS
We can do questions at the end.

ALEX
(insincere)
What if it's an emergency?

Tess gives her a look - *really?*

MS. ALEXANDER
If you have an emergency, then you
can say something.

TESS
But, hopefully that won't happen.
Now, as I was saying-

Damien raises his hand.

TESS (CONT'D)
(gritted)
What?

DAMIEN
I have an emergency.

No one replies.

DAMIEN (CONT'D)
I need to use the bathroom.

TESS
THAT'S NOT AN EMERGENCY!

DAMIEN
I'm trying to hold it, but I don't
know.

MS. ALEXANDER
Please don't pee on my carpet,
there's a bathroom just upstairs.

TESS
Just go, we'll wait.

Damien nods, and gets up to leave, but then--

DAMIEN
Sorry, false alarm.

TESS
Sit back down! Let me get this out
and then you guys can do whatever
you want, but I need to say
something.

ALEX
We're listening, Tess, I promise.

Tess sobers up a bit.

TESS
I'm okay with you guys continuing
to be friends-

ALEX
Really?!

TESS
On the following conditions. Number
one, no more staying up past your
bedtimes, that includes you Damien.

Damien rolls his eyes.

TESS (CONT'D)
Number two, you have to go back to
school on your own.

Alex jumps at this.

ALEX
That's no fair, he's my only friend
at school!

CORY
Hey!

ALEX
Beside you, sorry Cory.

TESS
I understand, but I'm not done
talking. The school is already
making changes to their security,
and we don't to make them any more
scared. Can I continue?

Alex sits back with her arms crossed.

TESS (CONT'D)

Thank you. Finally, you guys cannot go anywhere without first telling us. If you can accept these three things, you can hang out and be friends all you like. And I really want you guys to, I just need to make sure you're being safe.

MS. ALEXANDER

We're doing this out of love, you guys. Please know that.

TESS

Now, any questions?

Alex starts to raise an invisible hand then remembers and puts it down.

CORY

Can we still have sleepovers?

Ms. Alexander considers this, then looks at Tess.

MS. ALEXANDER

What do you think?

TESS

I think if you guys are following the rules, then it's good with me.

Ms. Alexander nods in agreement.

CORY

Awesome!

DAMIEN

These terms are acceptable. Thank you for your patience with me.

TESS

Of course, Damien. I want Alex to have friends, and if you're as caring as she said you were, then I have no problem with you, I only worried when I didn't know where she was or what you guys were doing.

DAMIEN

A loving mother always cares most for their child. I'd have it no other way.

Tess gives an accepting smile.

TESS
Alex? What do you say?

ALEX
Thank you. I- didn't think you
would let us be friends, I guess.
We'll follow all those rules,
believe me, I don't want any of
this happening again.

TESS
I'm so happy to hear you say that.

MS. ALEXANDER
Look at that you guys, we're all
friends again! Isn't this great?

They all smile and nod in agreement.

Cory raises a hand, all of a sudden.

TESS
What is it, Cory?

CORY
I think I have an emergency.

CUT TO:

INT. CORY'S HOUSE - CORY'S BASEMENT - LATER

Alex, Cory, and Damien are hanging out on the couch with
blankets and pillows all around.

CORY
So, when are we going to sleep?

DAMIEN
I'm fairly sleep-y, sleep-y? Is
that a word?

ALEX
I think so.

DAMIEN
I might turn in.

ALEX
Turn in?

DAMIEN
It means go to sleep.

ALEX
Huh?

DAMIEN
Forget it, goodnight children.

ALEX
Wait, actually, can we talk about something.

DAMIEN
Is something troubling you little one?

ALEX
We never talked about what happened at the mall.

DAMIEN
I thought we did all the talking we needed with Tess.

ALEX
Yeah, I know, but I still wanted to ask you some things.

DAMIEN
This isn't about clothes is it? I am at my wit's end with fitting rooms, okay-

ALEX
No, forget the clothes. Why did you run away from me when the police found us?

Damien's caught off guard by this.

DAMIEN
I don't feel like discussing this right now.

ALEX
Damien, please. Why do you keep running away?

DAMIEN
I don't want to hurt you, Alex. Maybe, we shouldn't spend so much time together.

ALEX

What are you talking about?

DAMIEN

I left you at the mall, because I didn't want you to be thrown in jail with me. I was trying to save you.

ALEX

Save me? You abandoned me! I haven't felt more alone in my entire life. I'm losing myself.

DAMIEN

Alex, I'm sorry, we can still be friends. I just can't hurt you any longer.

ALEX

You already have.

Alex lifts her hands to show Damien what's happened.

DAMIEN

What is this? What's wrong with your hands?

ALEX

I don't know, they started disappearing last night. Now, most of my arms are gone.

DAMIEN

Merlin's beard.

ALEX

Do you know him, can he help with this?

DAMIEN

It's just an expression.

ALEX

I need you to help make this stop. It's spreading. I don't how much time I have.

DAMIEN

This is all my fault. I'm so sorry.

ALEX

What do you mean?

DAMIEN

You need to know the truth, Alex.

Alex's eyes widen, her demeanor unsure if she's ready for what Damien is about to say.

DAMIEN (CONT'D)

You're right about me. I keep running. I've been running ever since I got here.

ALEX

I don't understand.

DAMIEN

I used to be knight. In my world, I was part of my father's army in King Meras's Legion, but I never had the heart for all the violence that came along with that responsibility.

ALEX

Why didn't your dad take you out?

DAMIEN

He always wanted his son to be a great warrior, and ever since I was born, he began training me as such. Even though I was never interested, I played along to please him. He was proud of me, but I felt guilty.

ALEX

Did your mom know?

DAMIEN

My mother was Queen Lillian of our kingdom, but she always wanted what was best for me. I complained to her, but I never asked her to say something to my father, I didn't want to disappoint him. That wish failed when the dragon attacked.

ALEX

I thought you slaid dragons with the other knights?

DAMIEN

I lied to you, I didn't want to disappoint you either.

(MORE)

DAMIEN (CONT'D)

One evening, during dinner, a dragon broke through the ceiling and attacked my family. My father urged me to help fight the dragon, to save my mother and sister, but I was too afraid. I felt small, and powerless, and I couldn't bare witness what was happening in front of me... so I ran away. I ran as far as I could, until I reached a wizard who lived just outside our castle's perimeter. I asked him to send me away, and I ended up here.

ALEX

This whole time, you were running away from being a knight?

DAMIEN

I wanted a new life. I thought, I found that with you here, but I realize I've ruined another one just the same. That's why I ran then, and that's why I ran here.

ALEX

I can't imagine what that must feel like.

DAMIEN

It doesn't matter. My family-

His voice breaks a little.

DAMIEN (CONT'D)

My family is gone, now. I have a chance to save at least one life, here, with you. I promise I will help you fix this.

ALEX

So, what does this have to do with me?

DAMIEN

The wizard said something to me before he sent me here. He told me there'd be a price for my wish, but nothing happened to me, so I thought I'd already paid it somehow.

ALEX

But instead, I got to pay the price. Classic.

DAMIEN

I'm terribly sorry for this, but now that I know what caused this, perhaps I can reverse it.

ALEX

So, where do we start?

DAMIEN

The first place I'd search for answers, is perhaps the place you found me first.

ALEX

Outside?

DAMIEN

Do you have a better idea?

ALEX

Not in the slightest.

Damien gets up, and heads for outside.

Alex gets up to follow him but-

CORY

Wait, can I come?

ALEX

Yeah, of course. Why didn't you say something earlier?

CORY

I don't know, you guys were being so serious, and all. I didn't want to interrupt anything.

Alex giggles, and Cory smiles sheepishly.

ALEX

Let's go break this spell.

CORY

Woohoo! Magic stuff!

EXT. CORY'S BACKYARD - CONTINUOUS

Damien searches the backyard for indications of magic where he first fell into this world.

Close behind, Alex and Cory join him.

DAMIEN

Cory, do you have any idea where exactly I showed up first?

CORY

Yeah, there was this huge shield shaped mark in the dirt that I covered with a rock. It's over here.

They all walk over with him.

Cory points at a spot, and Damien moves a rock that sits on top.

ALEX

See anything?

DAMIEN

I think that's where my nose was.

ALEX

Anything magic?

Damien traces his hand over the spot in an effort to find clues.

DAMIEN

Not even slightly.

ALEX

Are you even trying?

CORY

Wait, I have an idea! You should lay down on the ground the way you fell.

DAMIEN

What would that do?

CORY

You know, like retrace your steps, that usually helps me.

DAMIEN

I don't think-

ALEX
That's actually a great idea. Do
it, Damien.

DAMIEN
Really?

He's met with expecting expressions.

DAMIEN (CONT'D)
This is a waste of time.

He proceeds to begrudgingly lay down in the dirt carefully,
attempting to recreate the moment.

Once he's down there, he lifts his head after a few moments
to talk.

DAMIEN (CONT'D)
Yeah, this isn't doing anything.

ALEX
Put your face in.

DAMIEN
I'm not putting my face- this is
mud! It's rained since then!

CORY
You have to put your face in or
you're not retracing your steps.

Damien shoots a look at Alex, but she returns it with a
defiant one.

He sighs one last time before he slowly places his hand in
the ground.

Damien lies still for a few seconds, but the kids just laugh
at him.

DAMIEN
Alright, that's enough, I'm done
here!

Damien gets up annoyed.

DAMIEN (CONT'D)
I haven't the faintest idea where
to go from here, and this is
becoming tiresome.

ALEX

Oh quit complaining, we're just having a little fun with you.

DAMIEN

This is fun for you? All I've done today is make one mistake after another, and made your life worse time and time again. I just want to do something right.

ALEX

You're helping me that's all that counts.

DAMIEN

I wish I had some kind of guide.

Alex is struck by this visibly.

ALEX

Of course! A guide, you're a genius! I have a guide, I have all the guides!

DAMIEN

What're you on about?

ALEX

Follow me!

Alex runs back towards the house, and Cory follows without thinking.

Damien looks confused, but trails behind anyway.

INT. CORY'S HOUSE - CORY'S BASEMENT - CONTINUOUS

Alex makes it to her book bag on the couch, and starts pulling out all her storybooks.

Damien and Cory enter right after.

DAMIEN

What are you looking for?

ALEX

I'm not looking for anything, I have it all. I've showed you these storybooks before, I think they can help us.

CORY

Ooh, you think they have magic?!

DAMIEN

This is silly, what's a story going to do? Even if it was magic, we have no idea how to use it.

ALEX

I don't know anything about magic, but I know everything that's in these books, and I don't think that you fell into my world as a coincidence.

DAMIEN

You think you willed me here?

ALEX

I think the books can help us. Will you read with me?

DAMIEN

I'll try anything at this rate. Where's the one with the knight, I figure I should start with that one.

ALEX

I lost it.

DAMIEN

What? How? That may have been the only thing that could save you.

ALEX

Maybe, but I believe whatever we need is in any of these books.

CORY

What should I do?

ALEX

We're all going to grab a book, and just start reading, but as you're reading, think about how to fix this, think about how to find magic, think about all the things you want in the world.

CORY

Even, like, a big lego set?

ALEX
Even that.

DAMIEN
Anything?

ALEX
Everything.

Damien lets this sink in, and then grabs his book. The other two grab books of their own and they all start reading.

Alex reads about Goldilocks, and a smile with a twinge of sadness crosses her face.

Cory reads about Peter Pan, and can't help but laugh.

Damien reads about Alice in Wonderland and a hint of desperation can be seen on his face.

As the group reads on, they're feelings grow on their face, and magic starts to brew in the room.

The books from Alex's bag start floating up, along with the books in their hands.

They read until they can't anymore, and the books whirl around in the air, creating a big circle and

POOF!

A PORTAL OPENS in the middle of the room.

ALEX (CONT'D)
We did it!

CORY
I used magic?!!

DAMIEN
I can't believe it actually worked.

They all stand awestruck at what's in front of them.

Alex tries to reach her hand inside, but Damien pulls it back.

DAMIEN (CONT'D)
Careful, we don't really know what does.

ALEX
Aren't you tired, Damien?

DAMIEN
I beg your pardon?

ALEX
Aren't you tired of not believing
in yourself?

Damien stutters speechless.

ALEX (CONT'D)
Look at what's in front of you. We
brought magic from your world. I'm
sure you enjoyed the tour I gave
you of this place, but now it's
time to show me where you came
from.

DAMIEN
I don't know if I can go back. I'm
not ready.

ALEX
Well, I am. Cory, make sure Tess
doesn't freak out. See you soon!

Without another word--

POOF!

Alex JUMPS IN.

Damien is left with a choice to make. He looks at Cory for
help.

DAMIEN
Can I do this?

CORY
You're a knight, of course you can
do this.

Damien can't help but smile, and Cory returns it with all his
teeth.

Damien takes a deep breath, and--

POOF!

EXT. FAIRYTALE LAND - MAGIC FOREST - SAME TIME

Alex gets up off familiar ground, the same ground we saw
Damien leave his world in the beginning.

She has a moment where she takes in the world around her, no words, just big eyes.

Damien comes crashing in after her, and lands in the same spot she does.

DAMIEN
That never gets softer.

ALEX
Didn't think you'd come.

DAMIEN
You inspired me.

Alex smiles, and helps him up.

ALEX
Any idea where to go from here?

DAMIEN
Last time I-

Suddenly, the WIZARD shows up behind them.

THE WIZARD
I've been expecting you two.

DAMIEN AND ALEX
AHHHHHHH!!!

THE WIZARD
(chuckles)
I had no intention of startling you, but I couldn't help notice the magic you conjured in your world.

ALEX
That was you?

THE WIZARD
You opened the portal, I had no hand in that, but I felt every word spoke and every word thought.

ALEX
Then, you know I need help.

Alex shows the wizard the parts of her that are still invisible.

THE WIZARD
Ah yes, this was the consequences of your knight's decisions.

DAMIEN

How can we reverse this?

THE WIZARD

To remove the consequences, you must reverse the decision altogether.

DAMIEN

I don't understand.

THE WIZARD

Let me make it simple.

The wizard makes a wave of his hands, and before them all, the magic forest TRANSFORMS into what was once the GRAND CASTLE Damien lived in.

DAMIEN

What have you done?

THE WIZARD

If you want to help the child, you must help yourself. When I sent you to her world, it was not for your nobility.

DAMIEN

I know I've made mistakes, but this was destroyed. My family is gone.

THE WIZARD

They mustn't stay that way. Through the purity of your heart, and the magic you conjured, I can grant you a second chance at the life you once had.

Damien looks at Alex worried.

ALEX

What do you mean exactly?

THE WIZARD

The castle stands before you where you once abandoned your family who was under attack. I may drop you back in a time before this moment and allow you to act differently.

ALEX

And that would fix everything?

THE WIZARD

The choices you make can fix it
all.

Alex tries to object, but Damien steps up now.

DAMIEN

We must do it.

ALEX

Wait, when you say fix, do you mean
Damien will no longer live in my
world?

The wizard nods.

ALEX (CONT'D)

Well, that won't fix anything. This
is a terrible idea.

DAMIEN

Alex.

ALEX

No, I won't even consider it.

DAMIEN

I have a chance to save my family.
Do you really expect me to turn
that down?

ALEX

I thought I was your family.

DAMIEN

You are, but that doesn't change
the fact that I could stop my
sister, my mother, or my father
from dying. Imagine how much family
we could have if we could do that.

ALEX

I can't be part of your family, you
guys are royalty.

DAMIEN

You don't think your royalty? I'll
make it official then.

Damien grabs a stick from the ground, and faces Alex straight
on.

ALEX

What're you doing?

Damien lifts the stick up to Alex's shoulder.

DAMIEN
I do thereby knight thee, Alex,
into the honorable order of King
Meras and Queen Lillian.

Alex looks up, as Damien moves the stick over her head and onto the her other shoulder.

DAMIEN (CONT'D)
Arise knight, and be recognized.

Alex stands and can't help, but smile.

THE WIZARD
Congratulations, your royal
highness.

ALEX
(giggles)
Shame, Cory would've love to see
this!

DAMIEN
(chuckles)
Yeah, he would have. But, first,
will you help me make things right?

ALEX
Absolutely, I will.

They both look at the wizard for direction.

THE WIZARD
Your test awaits you. Once you
enter, you'll know what to do.

DAMIEN
Thank you for this opportunity.

THE WIZARD
Don't thank me, it came from within
you.

The knight nods courteously, and Alex waves as they begin up the stairs.

INT. CASTLE ENTRANCE - CONTINUOUS

They enter into a grand foyer, Alex can't help, but marvel while Damien focuses on finding his way.

ALEX
This is stunning.

DAMIEN
My family was very rich, our kingdom was healthy, and so we lived in luxury. Although, the bathrooms were never that comfortable, I don't know how your world came up with that.

ALEX
Are your toilets gold?

DAMIEN
Most of them.

ALEX
Wow.

DAMIEN
C'mon, up here.

Damien leads her up a staircase.

INT. CASTLE ARMORY - CONTINUOUS

Damien leads Alex straight to weapons and armor.

DAMIEN
We're going to need this equipment.

ALEX
What am I signing up for again?

DAMIEN
A big dragon is going to attack my family while they're having dinner, and we need to defeat it.

ALEX
Uh huh, and so you haven't done this before, right?

DAMIEN
Not so much, no. Take this.

Damien hands her a dagger.

ALEX
Why so small? Give me a real sword.

DAMIEN

Can you pick up a real sword?

Alex walks over to one, and tries to lift, but immediately gives up.

ALEX

Forget it, this one's faster.

DAMIEN

Right. Dragon means fire, so you're also going to need a shield, and to go with that, you're very own armor.

Damien holds up armor perfectly sized for her.

DAMIEN (CONT'D)

I guess the wizard made a version of this castle that has stuff for you now.

Alex grabs it excitedly and begins to put it on.

ALEX

How do I look?

DAMIEN

Like you belong on the round table.

ALEX

You actually have one of those?!

DAMIEN

Of course, I'll show you if we get out of this.

ALEX

C'mon, the knight always slays the dragon. This is going to be easy.

Damien flinches from this.

DAMIEN

Alex, listen to me. This isn't going to be fun, or easy. I know this is all very awesome to you and you're excited, but this will be dangerous, and I need to know that you're going to follow my lead. Can I count on you?

Alex puts a fist over heart.

ALEX
You have my word.

Just then, a big laugh can be heard in the nearby distance.

DAMIEN
That's our cue. I think my sister
just insulted my, Dad.

ALEX
Why are they laughing?

DAMIEN
We like to poke at each other.
Follow me, we have to get in
position.

INT. CASTLE DINING HALL - CONTINUOUS

Alex and Damien watch as Damien's family have dinner
together.

DAMIEN
There I am, sitting next to my
sister. When the dragon attacks,
I'm going to freeze, but that's
when we need to help.

ALEX
Why don't we go now, and get them
out of there before the dragon
comes?

DAMIEN
There can't be two of me. I need to
do what I couldn't before. We'll
time it.

They watch on as the scene plays out.

QUEEN LILLIAN
He has a point.

KING MERAS
No, he doesn't. Castle's are named
after great rulers and fighters,
not something you would know.

Everyone falls silent at this remark.

ALEX
That wasn't very nice.

DAMIEN
My father didn't have a light
tongue.

Just then, the DRAGON breaks in. Everything becomes chaos.

DAMIEN (CONT'D)
Here we go.

Alex gets up, about to run.

ALEX
I'm going.

DAMIEN
No, wait, I need you to watch my
past self leave, and make sure he
doesn't see me.

ALEX
But, I want to help!

DAMIEN
You are helping, I need you to do
this.

Damien's past self runs off.

DAMIEN (CONT'D)
I'm going in, keep yourself safe!

Damien runs into the frenzy while Alex keeps an eye on the
other Damien.

Damien aids King Meras first. He brandishes a sword, and
covers his father from flames with a shield.

DAMIEN (CONT'D)
I'm here father!

KING MERAS
You're a good man! We need to keep
the dragon at bay or else it could
take the whole castle down!

DAMIEN
I can distract if for now if you
can find a way to make it
vulnerable!

King Meras nods, and starts to move away slowly, looking for
a different opening.

Meanwhile, a piece of the FLOOR falls away and Queen Lillian and Princess Shelby find themselves in DANGER.

They both scream, but to no attention from either of the men.

Alex, on the other hand, HEARS them.

ALEX
(to herself)
You can save them. You have
superpowers, the dragon can't hurt
you. You're a knight now. Damien
needs you. You're family needs you!

She psyches herself up and SHE RUSHES INTO ACTION!

Alex makes her way past Damien and King Meras as they're fighting the dragon, using her partial invisibility to pass UNDETECTED.

Princess Shelby starts to slip, but Alex hurries.

A burst of FLAME gets in her way, but she blocks it with her shield!

Just before Princess Shelby falls, Alex CATCHES her and helps her to safety.

At the same time, Damien draws the Dragon low enough and lands a shot on its SNOUT.

As the dragon reels, King Meras manages a BLOW to its EYE.

They turn the tide in the fight, but suddenly, Queen Lillian SCREAMS.

Damien turns to her attention just in time to see his MOTHER FALL.

EXT. CASTLE ENTRANCE - CONTINUOUS

Queen Lillian moves through the air at an alarming rate, but Damien JUMPS DOWN AFTER HER!

In a heroic attempt, he reaches his mother in the air, WRAPS his BODY around hers.

Damien closes his eyes, BRACES for IMPACT when--

POOF!

Just like magic, they land safely at the castle entrance.

When he looks up, there's no more dragon, no more destruction, and no more danger.

QUEEN LILLIAN
Damien, are you alright?

DAMIEN
Mother?

QUEEN LILLIAN
My beautiful boy, you have the
bravest soul I've ever seen.

They hug tightly and rejoice in their reunion.

Just then, Princess Shelby and king come out the front doors with Alex just behind.

PRINCESS SHELBY
Mom!

Princess Shelby runs into open arms, and King Meras joins in too.

Alex looks on as Damien and his family hug.

He finally notices Alex and steps away for a moment.

DAMIEN
Alex, you're amazing! You saved us,
you were the best knight I'd ever
seen!

Damien rushes up to her and hugs her.

ALEX
I couldn't've done it without you.

DAMIEN
Yes, you could. But, we're always
stronger as family.

Her eyes sparkle as she internalizes this.

Damien turns to his family.

DAMIEN (CONT'D)
Everyone, I'd like to introduce to
you the newest member of our royal
army, this kingdom's savior, and my
best friend. Alex!

ALEX
I would wave, but my hands are-

She looks down and her hands are no longer invisible. In fact, none of her is invisible anymore, she's CURED.

ALEX (CONT'D)
Damien, I think we did it.

DAMIEN
You think.

Everyone in the family walks up to Alex to welcome her.

PRINCESS SHELBY
Hi Alex! You look stunning in your armor by the way. Dad never lets girls in his army, but you look better than all of them. You're going to love being here, and we can be sisters!

They hug, and Queen Lillian comes next.

QUEEN LILLIAN
Dear child, I'm indebted to you. I owe you the lives of my family. As queen, I'm a mother to everyone in my kingdom, but for you, I reserve my love.

Queen Lillian gives Alex a loving kiss on the forehead, and King Meras comes approaches next.

KING MERAS
You earned a knighthood far before today, little one, but I value a friend of Damien's as more than just a warrior. I'd have you as one of my closest advisors, with Damien, should you please. I can always learn something from someone like you. Thank you for what you've done for my family already.

King Meras smiles, and magically the Wizard appears last.

THE WIZARD
It seems you made the right choices.

DAMIEN
They were easier with Alex with me.

ALEX
I was just following your lead.

THE WIZARD

Always stronger together, but
strong on your own too. You've each
made better lives for yourselves.
Your last choice is where you live
it.

Alex and Damien look at each other like they knew this was
coming.

DAMIEN

Alex, we would all love if you
stayed with us in our kingdom, in
our castle, as part of our family.
You earned it, you're one of us.

Damien's entire family give gestures of approval.

ALEX

I love you guys. All I've ever
wanted was to live in a fairy tale.
Now that I'm here, it just feels
like something I should keep for my
story books - it's just not
something I could live every day.
I'm sorry, please don't be mad.

Alex starts to get sad, but Damien catches it immediately.

DAMIEN

Mad? You just made me the happiest
person alive. You reunited me with
my family, you made me feel like an
actual knight, and you helped me
experience what good toilets should
feel like.

Alex laughs.

DAMIEN (CONT'D)

I can't be mad at you, Alex, don't
you know that? That's why I did all
those silly things you asked me to
do. I love you.

Alex falls into a hug with him.

ALEX

I'm going to miss you.

DAMIEN

I'm going to miss you, too.
Remember, you'll always have a
family here.

ALEX
Visit me anytime on Earth, that's
allowed right, Mr. Wizard?

THE WIZARD
I'm certain we can make something
work.

Alex gives a toothy smile, and Damien returns it.

ALEX
I think I'm ready to go, then.

THE WIZARD
As you wish.

DAMIEN
Wait! One last thing!

He rushes up to her.

DAMIEN (CONT'D)
Take this.

He hands her a book.

ALEX
This isn't a new storybook, is it?

DAMIEN
Not exactly, but I thought you
needed something to replace the one
you lost. There's instructions
inside, just promise me not to open
it until tomorrow, at least.

ALEX
I promise.

They give each other one final hug before they separate.

THE WIZARD
Bid your farewells.

Alex waves to the royal family who wave back.

ALEX
Bye, your majesties!

The Wizard makes a wave of his hands, and--

POOF!

INT. CORY'S BASEMENT - CONTINUOUS

Alex finds herself in the same place she entered the portal, as if she never left.

Cory looks CONFUSED and SCARED.

CORY
What happened?!

ALEX
Oh my god. How long has it been?

CORY
Like two seconds, I didn't even go upstairs yet.

ALEX
Wow... amazing.

CORY
Where's Damien.

ALEX
I have a crazy story to tell you.

CUT TO:

INT. SCHOOL - HOME ROOM - THE NEXT DAY

Alex scribbles a note on her journal, then tears it into a scrap to pass to Cory.

She tries to toss it onto his desk, but JACK intercepts it.

He reads the note to himself, and giggles, then turns to Alex to tease her.

JACK
This is so stupid, why is your handwriting weird like-

ALEX
ROOOOAAAARRRRRRR!

Alex imitates a familiar Dragon, and scares the crap out of Jack. He immediately shuts up.

Alex sits back down triumphantly. Cory notices the interaction, and they share a giggle quietly.

INT. FOSTER HOME - ALEX'S BEDROOM - LATER

Alex sits on her bed quietly as she opens the book Damien gave her.

She reads the instructions on the front carefully, then turns the page. The book opens to a blank piece of lined paper.

Alex rummages for a pencil in her book bag, and starts writing on the page.

It starts with, "Today I fought bullies like a Dragon...", and she writes for a couple seconds.

When she's done, she patiently waits, staring at her words on the page.

Suddenly, Magically, NEW WORDS appear under hers.

They start with, "Today I defeated Trolls under a Bridge, and went Horseback riding with my Mother, and...".

Alex reads on about Damien's day, and she writes back too!

When they're done, they sign off with signatures and love, and Alex closes the book.

THE END